



Rishikesh Resort & Spa. “Modern travellers are actively seeking destinations that offer authentic access to heritage and reflection. Our hotels along the Ganges reflect how we are responding to this shift, each in its own idiom.”

Mishra believes luxury brands now play a larger role than simply providing accommodation. “As this segment of travel continues to grow, as hoteliers we see our role as custodians of that experience, blending authentic heritage, thoughtful architecture and the warmth of signature hospitality to help guests slow down and reconnect with themselves.”

That philosophy is evident at Taj Rishikesh Resort & Spa, tucked away in the Himalayan foothills, where the property deliberately distances guests from the bustle of the pilgrimage town without disconnecting them from its spiritual essence.

Guests witness the evening Ganga *aarti* on its private pebble beach, practice yoga overlooking the river, undergo Ayurvedic therapies at J Wellness Circle and explore nearby Devprayag, forests and Himalayan trails. The architecture itself borrows from Garhwali villages and temple forts, using local stone and timber to cre-

ate a sense of belonging rather than theatrical luxury.

Further downstream, IHCL’s restored heritage residences in Haridwar—Pilibhit House and Hari Ganga Niwas—illustrate another dimension of the Moksha economy. Instead of competing with the frenetic crowds at Har Ki Pauri, both properties leverage one increasingly valuable luxury commodity: privacy.

Each offers rare private bathing ghats where guests can perform rituals, take a customary dip or participate in personalised pujas away from thousands of pilgrims. Experiences extend to *bhajan*